Activity A6 - Run an Environmental Emergency Tabletop

Course: Fundamentals of ISO 14001 Environmental Management System (EMS) (TGS-2023037592) Ability: A3, A4 Objective: Determine, communicate and evaluate actions for a credible environmental emergency. Mode: Team analysis with individual evidence submission Suggested time: 60 minutes

Scenario

At 10:20 a forklift punctures a 600-litre water-based ink tote. Product flows toward an internal drain. One operator raises the alarm; the quantity released, drain destination and regulatory notification threshold are initially uncertain.

Meridian EcoPack Pte Ltd (MEP) is a fictional Singapore SME with 120 employees producing printed corrugated and fibre-based packaging for regional food, electronics and healthcare customers. Two key customers require evidence of an ISO 14001:2026-aligned EMS and stronger value-chain environmental controls before contract renewal.

Task and expected output

Respond to an ink-tote spill near a storm-water drain while protecting people, the environment and evidence integrity.

Produce: A time-stamped response log, notification decision record, containment plan and post-drill improvement actions.

Before you begin

- Open a working copy of the Excel workbook; do not overwrite the supplied evidence.
- Allocate a facilitator, evidence recorder, checker and presenter.
- Read every evidence card before making a compliance or significance conclusion.
- If the activity concerns an incident, this is a tabletop exercise: do not handle chemicals or simulate unsafe physical actions.

Decision questions

1. What must happen in the first 5, 15 and 60 minutes, and who has authority to act?
2. Which conditions require internal escalation, external notification or specialist confirmation?
3. What evidence must be protected for recovery, investigation, compliance evaluation and learning?

Detailed procedure

Step 1 - Assign incident controller, safety, containment, communications, facilities and recorder roles

Assign incident controller, safety, containment, communications, facilities and recorder roles.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 2 - Read the initial inject, stop unsafe work, raise the alarm and establish immediate human/environmental protection priorities

Read the initial inject, stop unsafe work, raise the alarm and establish immediate human/environmental protection priorities.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 3 - Identify the substance, quantity, pathway, receptors and control points; isolate the source only when safe

Identify the substance, quantity, pathway, receptors and control points; isolate the source only when safe.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 4 - Deploy drain protection and spill containment conceptually using the site plan and available resources

Deploy drain protection and spill containment conceptually using the site plan and available resources.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 5 - Use the notification decision tree, record uncertainties, obtain competent advice and make time-stamped communications

Use the notification decision tree, record uncertainties, obtain competent advice and make time-stamped communications.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 6 - Plan waste recovery, clean-up verification, restoration and evidence retention

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 7 - Debrief against objectives; log corrective actions, owners, dates and the next drill or competence check

Debrief against objectives; log corrective actions, owners, dates and the next drill or competence check.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Evidence to submit

- Completed Activity-A6-Workbook.xlsx.
- One evidence-backed team decision and one documented peer challenge.
- Any assumption or missing source clearly labelled for follow-up.

Acceptance checklist

[ ] The team protects people and receptors, records decisions and uncertainties, uses the approved escalation path, preserves evidence and converts drill findings into owned improvement actions.

[ ] Claims are traceable to supplied or cited evidence.

[ ] Assumptions, uncertainty and missing evidence are labelled.

[ ] Owners, due dates and next decisions are included where applicable.

[ ] Legal/compliance interpretations needing competent advice are escalated rather than guessed.

[ ] A peer challenge and response are recorded.

Troubleshooting

- The team cannot agree on a score: return to the criterion anchors and record each evidence-based assumption before averaging or escalating.
- Evidence is missing: do not invent it; record an evidence gap, risk implication, owner and retrieval action.
- A legal requirement is unclear: record the current authoritative source and escalate to a competent adviser or authority channel.
- A conclusion feels obvious: test an alternative explanation and state what evidence would falsify the current view.

Facilitator debrief

Ask each team to defend one priority, control or conclusion using objective evidence. Probe what would change the decision, then connect the work to PDCA and the relevant EMS process rather than clause memorisation.

Files in this activity pack

- README.md and README.pdf - detailed learner procedure.
- Activity-A6-Scenario-and-Checklist.pdf - printable scenario and completion checklist.
- Activity-A6-Workbook.xlsx - editable analysis and submission workbook.

Source and usage note

This fictional training activity paraphrases ISO 14001 concepts and is not legal advice or a reproduction of the standard. Use the organisation's licensed ISO 14001:2026 copy and current authoritative Singapore sources for formal interpretation.